

Recommended buys

Take a look at our product list where we list only the top three best performers from all categories along with their prices



From Google, to Android

Don't have an iPhone? No worries. You can now get directions from Google on your Android phone. <http://dgit.in/ggl2andrd>

- Does the case provide tool-free installation of components;
- Does it have all the front panel ports that you need. Most new cases these days have USB 3.0 ports on the front;
- Are there enough expansion slots for PCI/PCIe components that you plan on installing. For example, if you are going to install multiple video cards in SLI or CrossFire-X;
- If the particular case that you're looking at has tons of fans and you're someone who is a stickler for silent computing, then it's absolutely necessary that you take a look at a few reviews online so that you know how much noise the fans make. Depending on whether the case checks out according to you in terms of the noise that it emits, you can make an informed decision;
- Cable management is another aspect that buyers forget to take into consideration. You should check whether the selected case has cable routing holes around the motherboard tray, rubber grommets covering these routing holes, cable tying hooks at the back of the tray, and enough clearance at the back of the motherboard tray so that it's easy to close the side panel.
- Aesthetics is another important factor for quite a lot of buyers as they make their decision solely based on the looks of a case. We understand that looks are necessary, but overlooking everything else about the case in favour of looks is the worst mistake anyone can make. This is why, you should look for a case that offers the best of both world's i.e., temperature performance and features coupled with good looks.

What were the options available to us

All three of us stood inside a shop which was already jam packed and quite loud.

Since our requirements were varied, the shopkeeper had to dial a few different numbers on his phone to provide us with options that were available along with their different asking prices. The first few full-tower options that he suggested were all about three-to-four year old models. This didn't necessarily mean that they were bad, but since Mithun was willing to pay around ₹15K, he wanted something new and better. The shopkeeper then suggested three really good options: Cooler Master HAF Stacker 935, NZXT Phantom 820 and the Corsair Graphite 780T available for ₹14,950, ₹17,500 and ₹15,450 respectively. The Cooler Master HAF Stacker 935 was an interesting option as it provided an extra removable section which could be used separately for a mini-ITX based system or in tandem with a radiator box or even for mounting extra hard drives. The other two cases were designed brilliantly as they both looked different from most cases in that price range. After weighing out his options carefully, Mithun decided to go for the Corsair Graphite 780T (black version) for ₹15,450 because not only did it look good, but it was also really well made and had all the features that he wanted. If not for that, the costlier NZXT Phantom 820 was his next preferred option.

It was Siddharth's turn next and the Ant had a few options for him in mind since we had tested quite a lot of mid-tower cases around the ₹7K price bracket in the past year. We asked the shopkeeper to show us the NZXT Source 530 (which was marketed as a full-tower) and the Cooler Master 690 III. The NZXT was priced at ₹6,750 while the Cooler Master one came with a tag of ₹7,100. A direct comparison between the two showed that the Source 530 was more modular internally, had slightly more clearance for air coolers and graphics cards and was also cheaper than the 690 III. Which

is why, Siddharth happily selected more spacious NZXT Source 530 for ₹6,750. A really good choice in that price bracket. Finally, it was the Ant's turn and he wanted to buy a mid-tower. He had already narrowed down on a couple of mid-tower options in his budget like the good old Corsair Carbide 400R, the Corsair Carbide SPEC O3 and the slightly costlier Antec GX900. The Antec GX900 with the camo paint job caught his fancy as it was built really well and was of the right size that he was looking for and performed really well in our tests. It also featured an in-built fan-controller. He immediately went for it and paid ₹4,400 for it after a short bargaining session. The shopkeeper also showed us the new NZXT H230 Silent which was priced around ₹5K and I must say that it's an excellent and feature-rich option for people who are looking for a case primed for silence as their primary requirement.

As for my requirement of an HTPC case, although there were plenty of options available, it was surprising to see that these small mini-ITX cases had a price tag which was higher than their mid-tower counterparts. I asked the shopkeeper to show me the Silverstone Sugo Series SST-SG02B-F-USB3.0 and the old favourite Cooler Master Elite 130. Both these cases had similar designs but the all-black finish of the Elite 130 looked better. The Silverstone case was priced similarly but it was the overall build quality of the Cooler Master Elite 130 that prompted me to go for it for ₹3,600. Although, it meant that I had to extend my budget by more than one grand.

All in all, we were happy with our purchases as we also managed to bargain a bit and shave off around ₹1.5K in total. Since Mithun's case was the biggest, he had some trouble getting it home but it was nothing - a pricey cab ride couldn't take care of. 🚗

Gaming is a priority

This would probably be my first ever e-mail to you or the Digit team and I just want to make clear of my intention is to buy a new laptop. I know you guys a lot of such questions but I still need your help here! My

piggy bank budget is ₹50k to 55k.

- Priority 1: Gaming. For playing games like GTA 5 even at low or mid graphics without any lag;
- Priority 2: Decent battery backup at normal usage;

- Priority 3: Photoshopping and video editing;
 - Priority 4 : Good display. All the new features including USB 3;
- I'm having a hard time stating the specs so it would be much appreciated if you